

DOCUMENT 40

STUDENT FELLOW MASTER TRAINING & CERTIFICATION EXAM

Sponsorship Outreach • Research • AI • CRM • Meetings • Proposals • Fulfillment • Reporting

Purpose: Verify that a Student Fellow understands the sponsorship operating system before conducting independent outreach. Certification evaluates knowledge, judgment, research quality, written communication and CRM discipline.

Candidate: _____ **Date:** _____ **Evaluator:** _____

CERTIFICATION STANDARD

Score	Status	Authority
90-100	CERTIFIED — Independent Outreach	May conduct normal outreach independently within approved rules.
80-89	CERTIFIED — Supervised	May work with review of major communications/opportunities.
70-79	RETRAINING REQUIRED	Complete targeted retraining and retest.
Below 70	NOT CERTIFIED	May not represent the program independently.

AUTOMATIC-FAIL BEHAVIORS

Regardless of numerical score, certification may be denied for intentional fabrication of contacts/statistics; knowingly misrepresenting an organization as a sponsor; promising student/participant data; committing unauthorized naming rights, exclusivity or benefits; serious mishandling of confidential information; knowingly falsifying CRM records; or deliberate outreach practices that materially violate program rules.

PART I — KNOWLEDGE EXAM (40 POINTS)

Circle/select the best answer. 2 points each.

1. A prospect replies, “Sounds interesting. Send information.” What is the best status?

A. Confirmed Sponsor B. Qualified/Engaged Prospect C. Closed Won D. Payment Pending

Answer: _____

2. Before sending a personalized sponsorship email, the fellow should first:

A. Attach every document B. Research fit/contact/ask C. Promise benefits D. Call the CEO repeatedly

Answer: _____

3. Which is the strongest reason to attach a media kit?

A. Every first email needs one B. Prospect requested/needs detailed background C. It makes email longer D. Fellow has no personalization

Answer: _____

4. AI may be used to:

A. Invent missing statistics B. Guess private emails C. Draft from verified inputs D. Confirm a sponsor without evidence

Answer: _____

5. If a sponsor asks for exclusivity, a fellow should:

A. Agree immediately B. Offer category ownership C. Escalate to leadership D. Ignore the request

Answer: _____

6. A \$25,000 potential opportunity discussed in a meeting is:

A. Confirmed cash B. Qualified pipeline until confirmed C. Cash received D. Guaranteed revenue

Answer: _____

7. Which metric is safest to report when 5,000 flyers were handed out but readership was not measured?

A. 5,000 people reached B. 5,000 impressions C. 5,000 flyers distributed D. 5,000 participants

Answer: _____

8. A sponsor says there is no cash budget. Best next step?

A. End relationship B. Explore relevant in-kind/awareness/support pathways C. Demand \$5K D. Promise naming rights

Answer: _____

9. What should every CRM record contain after material outreach?

A. Only company name B. Last action, stage, next action/date and owner C. Personal opinion only D. Nothing until reply

Answer: _____

10. A fellow finds a likely contact on LinkedIn but cannot verify the email. They should:

A. Invent email format as confirmed B. Record as verified C. Continue verification/use legitimate channel D. Add random addresses

Answer: _____

11. Which is a leadership-level issue?

A. Correcting a typo before sending B. Naming rights request C. Logging a call D. Researching a website

Answer: _____

12. When should a custom proposal usually be built?

A. For every cold lead B. After qualified interest/request/discovery C. Before research D. Only after payment

Answer: _____

13. Cash and in-kind support should be reported:

A. Combined as cash B. Separately C. Only if over \$100K D. As social reach

Answer: _____

14. A strong first email should primarily be:

A. Long and generic B. Personalized, concise and relevant C. Full of attachments D. Focused on celebrity names

Answer: _____

15. If a prospect says “not my department,” the best response is:

A. Argue B. Ask for correct person/referral C. Mark sponsor confirmed D. Send daily emails

Answer: _____

16. Which statement is correct?

A. Interest equals sponsorship B. Proposal equals payment C. Confirmation requires the approved confirmation standard D. Meeting equals commitment

Answer: _____

17. Sponsor fulfillment begins:

A. Only next year B. After support is confirmed C. Before outreach D. After renewal

Answer: _____

18. A fellow may promise participant contact data when:

A. Sponsor pays \$100K B. Never without authorized privacy/legal process; escalate request C. Asked politely D. Data is useful

Answer: _____

19. Best measure of fellow performance is:

A. Email volume alone B. Quality + pipeline movement + CRM discipline + results C. Number of attachments D. Number of companies copied

Answer: _____

20. If a fact is missing from an impact report, AI should:

A. Estimate it B. Invent a plausible number C. Omit/mark unavailable D. Double another metric

Answer: _____

PART II — RESEARCH EXERCISE (20 POINTS)

Evaluator assigns one organization from the priority prospect library. Candidate has a defined research period and may use approved public research/AI tools.

Item	Candidate Work / Standard	Pts
Organization assigned		0
Why this organization fits	Write 2-4 evidence-based sentences.	5
Best department / decision-maker type	Identify the most relevant role/department and why.	4
Verified contact pathway	Official page/email/phone/LinkedIn or other legitimate route; distinguish verified from unverified.	4
Primary ask	Choose one specific cash/in-kind/strategic ask and explain why.	4
Secondary ask	Choose a sensible alternative.	2
CRM-ready source notes	Record source/date and next action.	1

Candidate notes:

PART III — OUTREACH WRITING EXERCISE (20 POINTS)

Using the organization researched in Part II, write a first-touch email and a follow-up. Do not invent facts or benefits.

A. FIRST-TOUCH EMAIL — 12 POINTS

Factor	Pts	Standard
Subject line	2	Relevant, professional, not misleading.
Opening personalization	2	Shows real organizational fit.
Program explanation	2	Accurate and concise.
Ask / call to action	3	Clear, appropriate and specific.
Tone / length / accuracy	2	Professional and easy to read.
Attachment judgment	1	Correctly chooses whether/what to attach.

Email draft:

B. FOLLOW-UP EMAIL — 8 POINTS

Factor	Pts
References prior outreach without sounding accusatory	2
Adds relevance/value rather than repeating entire email	2
Clear next step	2
Professional, concise, accurate	2

Follow-up draft:

PART IV — SPONSOR SCENARIO (10 POINTS)

Scenario: A major technology company replies: “This sounds interesting. Please send us information and sponsorship options. We are particularly interested in youth technology and AI education. Can you also tell us what visibility we would receive?”

Candidate: Explain exactly what you do next. Address CRM status, research, materials, ask, response, approved benefits, leadership review and follow-up.

Evaluation	Pts
Correctly classifies as engaged/qualified opportunity, not confirmed sponsor	1
Updates CRM and records exact interests/next action	1
Researches/validates company priorities and decision process	1
Selects relevant materials rather than attaching everything	1
Develops primary + secondary ask aligned to technology/AI	2
Uses only approved visibility/benefits; does not invent exclusivity/data/media	2
Escalates proposal/major terms to leadership review	1
Sets a dated follow-up / next step	1

Candidate response:

PART V — CRM EXERCISE (10 POINTS)

Using the scenario above, complete the CRM record as if you had just received the reply.

CRM Field	Candidate Entry	Pts
Organization	_____	1
Contact / Department	_____	1
Current Stage	_____	2
Primary Interest	_____	1
Primary Ask	_____	1
Secondary Ask	_____	1
Last Action	_____	1
Next Action + Owner	_____	1
Next Date	_____	1

FINAL EVALUATOR SCORECARD

Section	Score / Decision
Part I — Knowledge	/ 40
Part II — Research	/ 20
Part III — Outreach	/ 20
Part IV — Scenario	/ 10
Part V — CRM	/ 10
TOTAL	/ 100
Automatic Fail Trigger?	YES / NO
Final Status	Independent / Supervised / Retraining / Not Certified

Evaluator comments: _____

Evaluator Signature: _____ Date: _____

EVALUATOR ANSWER KEY — PART I

1. B 2. B 3. B 4. C 5. C

6. B 7. C 8. B 9. B 10. C

11. B 12. B 13. B 14. B 15. B

16. C 17. B 18. B 19. B 20. C

EVALUATOR GUIDANCE

Use judgment on written sections. Award points for accuracy, professional reasoning and compliance with the operating system—not for using identical wording to training documents. If a candidate makes a serious safety, privacy, integrity or authorization error, document it and apply the automatic-fail standard when appropriate.

Certification should be followed by supervised observation during the fellow's early live outreach. Passing an exam does not authorize actions that the underlying program rules reserve for leadership.

PROGRAM CONTACT

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